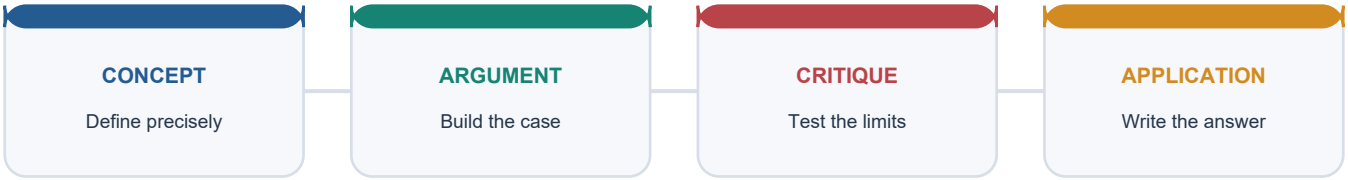
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Community-Based DRR and Inclusive Protection - Solved Practice Workbook

GS-III Disaster Management | 32 solved MCQs, PYQ applications and Mains models

LEARNING PATH



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Community-Based DRR and Inclusive Protection - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. A village committee maps flooded lanes but excludes a migrant settlement. What is the best correction?

A. Add migrant representatives and validate the map with them B. Accept the map because elected residents prepared it C. Remove social data and retain only water depth D. Transfer mapping entirely to an external consultant

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: representation and joint validation repair the blind spot.
- **B.** Election does not guarantee inclusion of tenants or migrants.
- **C.** Physical hazard data alone cannot capture access barriers.
- **D.** External expertise can support, but should not erase local participation.

Trap: Participatory mapping can reproduce exclusion unless representation is tested.

Q2. Which combination best represents co-production in CBDRR?

A. Community volunteers replace district authorities B. Community priorities combine with public authority, science and resources C. Administration decides and communities only receive instructions D. Private charity determines relief entitlement

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Replacement wrongly transfers State duty.
- **B.** Correct: co-production joins local agency and institutional capacity.
- **C.** One-way instruction is not meaningful participation.
- **D.** Charity cannot determine public entitlement.

Trap: Do not confuse participation with State withdrawal or ceremonial consultation.

Q3. A warning committee has local elders but no women, youth or persons with disabilities. The main risk is:

A. Too many scientific inputs B. Excessive district coordination C. A narrow knowledge base that misses group-specific barriers D. Automatic invalidity of every decision

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** The defect is representation, not science.
- **B.** District linkage is not the stated problem.
- **C.** Correct: homogeneous representation can hide safety and access barriers.
- **D.** Poor representation requires correction but does not logically erase all decisions.

Trap: Community is not homogeneous.

Q4. Which result would best demonstrate successful CBDRR?

A. A guideline was published B. A committee met twice C. One thousand volunteers were enrolled D. Mapped households received warnings, evacuated safely and corrected exclusion through feedback

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Publication is an input.
- **B.** Meetings show activity, not protection.
- **C.** Enrolment does not prove readiness.
- **D.** Correct: this traces receipt, action and accountability outcomes.

Trap: Use protection outcomes, not programme activity, as the final test.

Q5. Which use of local knowledge is strongest?

A. Combine route memory with updated hazard and infrastructure data B. Treat past experience as proof that the next hazard will be identical C. Ignore forecasts when local signs appear D. Restrict mapping to long-term landowners

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: local, scientific and administrative knowledge validate one another.
- **B.** Past patterns may change.
- **C.** Local observation complements rather than replaces scientific warning.
- **D.** Tenants and migrants may hold critical current information.

Trap: Local knowledge is valuable but not infallible.

Q6. Why must an assistance register be updated before each hazard season?

A. Because the DDMA cannot hold any data B. Household composition, disability, migration, medicines and transport needs change C. Because consent is irrelevant during emergencies D. Because one list should be publicly unrestricted

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** District systems can hold protected data.
- **B.** Correct: stale lists create false assurance and missed assistance.
- **C.** Consent and privacy remain relevant.
- **D.** Unrestricted publication can create privacy and protection risks.

Trap: A list is useful only if current, protected and activated.

Q7. A local flood map shows hazard depth but not shelters, transport or isolated households. It is primarily:

A. A complete risk map B. An evacuation order C. A partial hazard product lacking exposure and capacity information D. Proof of community readiness

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Risk includes more than hazard intensity.
- **B.** A map is not an authoritative evacuation order.
- **C.** Correct: operational decisions need exposure, vulnerability and capacity.
- **D.** Readiness requires plans, roles and drills.

Trap: Do not call a hazard layer a complete community risk map.

Q8. Which statement about scientific and local knowledge is most accurate?

A. Only scientists should determine feasible evacuation B. Only local residents should estimate hazard intensity C. Both forms should remain separate to avoid conflict D. They should be combined while preserving their different strengths and limits

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Feasibility needs household and route knowledge.
- **B.** Hazard intensity requires technical assessment.
- **C.** Separation prevents joint validation.
- **D.** Correct: integration improves both diagnosis and action.

Trap: Integration does not mean that every claim has equal evidentiary weight.

Q9. What is the safest first-responder role for a trained community volunteer?

A. Basic first aid, warning relay and evacuation support within defined protocols B. Entering an unstable structure without equipment C. Issuing an official cyclone forecast D. Declaring a district-level all-clear

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: these bounded bridge functions align with the source's tsunami example of SHG/NGO/CBO search-and-rescue support.
- **B.** Unsafe improvisation can create secondary casualties.
- **C.** Forecast authority belongs to competent agencies.
- **D.** All-clear decisions require authorised assessment.

Trap: Speed does not justify operating outside training and safety limits.

Q10. Which indicator best tests Aapda Mitra readiness rather than coverage?

A. Number of districts listed B. Refresher completion, equipment availability and activation performance C. Total press releases D. Number of scheme logos displayed

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** District coverage is an input.
- **B.** Correct: readiness requires maintained capability and use.
- **C.** Publicity does not measure operational capacity.
- **D.** Brand visibility has no protection value.

Trap: Volunteer counts should never be reported as outcome proof.

Q11. After a mock drill, the village records evacuation delays for wheelchair users and changes transport arrangements. This is:

A. Only awareness generation B. Post-disaster compensation C. A feedback loop improving inclusive preparedness D. Evidence that future evacuation is guaranteed

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** The drill goes beyond awareness.
- **B.** No compensation issue is involved.
- **C.** Correct: observed barriers change the plan.
- **D.** Improvement reduces risk but cannot guarantee outcomes.

Trap: A drill is useful when evaluated and used to correct the plan.

Q12. Which statement about community first response is incorrect?

A. Communities may act before external services arrive B. Roles should be assigned in advance C. Professional handover and referral matter D. Local volunteers should replace specialised response forces

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** This is a core reason for community capacity.
- **B.** Pre-assignment improves coordination.
- **C.** Handover protects safety and continuity.
- **D.** Correct: volunteers complement, not replace, specialised forces.

Trap: Reject both extremes: passive community and unsupported substitution.

Q13. A panchayat's strongest preparedness contribution is to:

A. Maintain local plans, assistance lists, services and DDMA links B. Issue national tsunami bulletins C. Command interstate force deployment D. Define international refugee law

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: these functions sit at local-government level.
- **B.** Tsunami advisories belong to competent national systems.
- **C.** Interstate deployment exceeds panchayat authority.
- **D.** Refugee-law definition is not a local function.

Trap: Assign institutions roles they can legally and operationally perform.

Q14. Why is ward-level planning necessary in a city?

A. Municipal boundaries eliminate local variation B. Street access, drainage, tenancy and social barriers vary within the city C. DDMAs cannot coordinate urban disasters D. Only wards can issue weather forecasts

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Cities contain sharp intra-urban variation.
- **B.** Correct: neighbourhood detail is essential for last-mile action.
- **C.** DDMAs retain district coordination.
- **D.** Forecasting remains with competent technical agencies.

Trap: Citywide planning without neighbourhood detail can miss the last mile.

Q15. Which arrangement best links community and district systems?

A. A private volunteer network with no activation contact B. A district plan with no ward data C. Named local focal points, shared protocols, exercises and escalation routes D. Informal messaging without official verification

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** No contact means no reliable activation.
- **B.** District plans need local intelligence.
- **C.** Correct: linkage must be operational and rehearsed.
- **D.** Unverified messaging risks confusion.

Trap: Institutional linkage is a process, not a list of organisations.

Q16. A local body conducts drills but never reviews failures. The missing element is:

A. Hazard occurrence B. Volunteer recruitment C. Official publicity D. After-action learning and plan revision

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Hazards need not occur for review.
- **B.** The scenario already has participants.
- **C.** Publicity does not correct performance.
- **D.** Correct: drills must generate learning.

Trap: A repeated drill can repeat the same exclusion unless findings change the plan.

Q17. Which role is especially suitable for SHGs during relief?

A. Identify excluded households and verify needs through transparent procedures B. Determine cyclone intensity C. Replace public health services D. Decide compensation secretly

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: SHGs can use local trust for verification.
- **B.** Hazard science is outside this role.
- **C.** Community institutions support but do not replace services.
- **D.** Secrecy increases exclusion risk.

Trap: Local trust should strengthen, not bypass, accountability.

Q18. What distinguishes Yuva Aapda Mitra from Aapda Mitra?

A. It is the old pilot's formal renamed phase B. It is a distinct youth programme reported across 315 districts with roughly 2.37 lakh volunteers C. It removes the need for district plans D. It certifies measured disaster-loss reduction

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** The programmes should not be collapsed.
- **B.** Correct: MHA/PIB reported this distinct scale on 29 October 2024.
- **C.** Volunteer training does not replace planning.
- **D.** Training numbers do not establish avoided loss.

Trap: Keep scheme identity, dated scale and outcome status separate.

Q19. Which volunteer policy best addresses attrition?

A. One induction with no contact afterward B. Recruiting only after disasters C. Refresher drills, role recognition, equipment and updated rosters D. Counting everyone ever trained as active

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Skills and contacts decay.
- **B.** Post-impact recruitment is too late.
- **C.** Correct: retention needs continuous institutional support.
- **D.** Historic training is not current availability.

Trap: Readiness is maintained, not permanently conferred.

Q20. When can local leadership become a risk?

A. Whenever it has hazard knowledge B. Whenever it supports evacuation C. Whenever it links to DDMA D. When elite capture excludes tenants, minorities or remote hamlets

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Knowledge is useful.
- **B.** Evacuation support is legitimate.
- **C.** Formal linkage is necessary.
- **D.** Correct: local power can reproduce social exclusion.

Trap: Localisation requires representation, transparency and appeal.

Q21. Which statement best defines attitudinal vulnerability in the source material?

A. A negative disposition toward change that can increase dependence on external support B. An inaccessible ramp or warning format C. Income poverty alone D. A permanent incapacity of every community

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: this is the source-named community-level concept.
- **B.** This is a physical or communication accessibility barrier.
- **C.** Economic and attitudinal vulnerability are distinct.
- **D.** The concept is contextual and should not become victim-blaming.

Trap: Do not confuse attitudinal vulnerability with disability-related attitudinal barriers or structural deprivation.

Q22. A relief package is equal but inaccessible to people without documents. The main issue is:

A. Too much equity B. Formal equality without equitable access C. Excessive scientific uncertainty D. Lack of hazard monitoring

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** The problem is not excessive adaptation.
- **B.** Correct: identical rules can produce unequal protection.
- **C.** No forecast issue is described.
- **D.** Monitoring does not correct document exclusion.

Trap: Equality of distribution is not equity of protection.

Q23. An older migrant woman with impaired mobility illustrates:

A. Only age vulnerability B. Only migration status C. Intersecting barriers that require combined support D. Proof that categories are useless

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** One category is incomplete.
- **B.** Migration alone is incomplete.
- **C.** Correct: combined barriers shape a distinct assistance need.
- **D.** Categories remain useful when not treated as silos.

Trap: Intersectionality improves precision; it does not prohibit classification.

Q24. Which plan avoids stereotyping vulnerable groups?

A. Assume all older persons need identical help B. Treat women only as victims C. Exclude persons with disabilities from volunteer roles D. Assess specific barriers and capacities with the group concerned

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Needs vary.
- **B.** Women are also responders and leaders.
- **C.** Persons with disabilities hold knowledge and capabilities.
- **D.** Correct: participation and functional assessment avoid stereotypes.

Trap: Inclusion must recognise both support needs and agency.

Q25. Which shelter measure is most gender-responsive?

A. Safe lighting, privacy, sanitation, health support and complaint access B. A single unlit sanitation block C. Relief distribution only through male household heads D. No women on shelter committees

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: safety, dignity, services and voice are linked.
- **B.** This can increase risk.
- **C.** Household-head rules can exclude women.
- **D.** Exclusion weakens design and accountability.

Trap: Gender responsiveness is a system, not one facility.

Q26. At a cyclone shelter, an unaccompanied child is entered only as 'unknown' and no tracing record is opened. What is the best immediate correction?

A. Move the child to a different unregistered shelter B. Create a protected registration and tracing record, appoint safeguarding support and begin family-link procedures C. Post the child's full personal details publicly D. Wait until schools reopen before recording the case

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Moving without documentation can deepen separation.
- **B.** Correct: protected registration, tracing and safeguarding address the specific protection failure.
- **C.** Unrestricted disclosure can create privacy and trafficking risks.
- **D.** Tracing must begin during response, not after educational recovery.

Trap: Child registration must support tracing and protection without exposing personal data.

Q27. An older dialysis patient reaches a shelter, but the caregiver and medicine record were sent to another facility. What should the plan prioritise?

A. Standard food distribution before any health review B. Transfer to any shelter without documenting treatment needs C. Rapid clinical referral, medicine and record continuity, and reconnection with the caregiver or accountable support D. Removal from the shelter register because specialist care is required

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Food is necessary but does not resolve the immediate continuity risk.
- **B.** Undocumented transfer can interrupt care again.
- **C.** Correct: this links health continuity, information and support-person coordination.

- **D.** Specialist need increases the duty to coordinate; it does not justify exclusion.

Trap: Care continuity requires records and referral links, not only accessible transport.

Q28. Which is the clearest gender-related recovery risk?

A. Restoration of safe livelihoods B. Representation in planning C. Reopening health services D. Compensation rules tied only to male land titles

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Livelihood restoration supports recovery.
- **B.** Representation improves design.
- **C.** Health continuity reduces vulnerability.
- **D.** Correct: title-based rules can exclude women from recovery resources.

Trap: Recovery rules can reproduce pre-disaster inequality.

Q29. Which warning design is disability-inclusive?

A. Audio, text and visual formats plus trusted relay and feedback B. A single small-font app notice C. Only a siren with no interpretation D. A route inaccessible to mobility devices

Answer: A.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Correct: multiple formats and feedback address varied barriers.
- **B.** This excludes many users.
- **C.** A siren may not convey meaning or reach people with hearing impairments.
- **D.** Information without feasible movement is incomplete.

Trap: Accessibility must cover warning, movement and shelter, not communication alone.

Q30. Section 8 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 is best used as:

A. Proof every district shelter is accessible B. A legal protection-and-safety anchor, not implementation proof C. Authority for IMD forecasts D. A refugee-status rule

Answer: B.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** An Act does not prove local delivery.
- **B.** Correct: legal status and implementation evidence are distinct.
- **C.** Forecast mandates are unrelated.
- **D.** The Act does not define refugee status.

Trap: Separate legal obligation from measured compliance.

Q31. Which statement about disaster displacement is accurate?

A. It automatically creates Convention refugee status B. It removes domestic protection duties C. It may create language, document, livelihood and protection barriers D. It affects only cross-border movement

Answer: C.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** The Convention test is persecution-based.
- **B.** Rights and duties remain.
- **C.** Correct: these barriers compound risk.
- **D.** Displacement can be internal.

Trap: Preserve both the legal-status distinction and the protection imperative.

Q32. Which relief mechanism best protects displaced tenants?

A. Require land title for all assistance B. Use only pre-disaster voter lists C. Rely on landlord certification alone D. Accept multiple proofs, register current residence and provide appeal

Answer: D.

Explanation (option-by-option):

- **A.** Title rules exclude tenants.
- **B.** Lists may be stale or omit migrants.
- **C.** Single-gate certification is vulnerable to exclusion.
- **D.** Correct: flexible verification plus appeal improves access.

Trap: Documentation rules should verify need without becoming a barrier.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

DIRECT PYQ - 2026 GS-III, Q18 - 15 marks, 250 words

Question: "Community participation is the cornerstone of effective disaster management." Analyse this statement with suitable examples from India. Also discuss the challenges to community participation and measures to strengthen it.

Alternative workbook model: Community participation is indispensable because disaster risk is experienced locally and formal responders rarely arrive first. Residents identify unsafe houses, isolated families, viable routes and trusted communication channels. Trained local volunteers can relay warnings, assist evacuation, provide first aid, verify relief and shape recovery. Odisha's cyclone preparedness uses local shelter committees and volunteers; during the 2018 Kerala floods, fishers and neighbourhood networks added rapid rescue capacity; Aapda Mitra institutionalises community training.

Participation nevertheless faces weak local-body capacity, irregular training, volunteer attrition, elite capture, exclusion of women, migrants and persons with disabilities, inaccessible warnings and uncertain links with DDMAs. It may become token consultation or unpaid substitution for State services.

Strengthening requires village and ward disaster plans linked to district plans; representative committees; participatory risk and resource maps; updated assistance registers; regular evaluated drills; equipment, insurance and refresher training for volunteers; multilingual and accessible alerts; dignified shelters; and transparent relief criteria with appeal. Monitoring should track warning receipt, evacuation completion and equitable recovery rather than meetings or enrolment alone.

Community participation is therefore a cornerstone only when it is representative, trained, resourced and institutionally connected - local ownership within accountable public governance.

PYQ examiner checklist

- Directly answer why participation matters.
- Use at least two Indian examples.
- Name implementation challenges, including exclusion.
- Propose institutional, capacity and accountability measures.
- End with co-production, not State withdrawal.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE - WORKBOOK MODELS

Original Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Explain why local knowledge must be combined with scientific knowledge in CBDRR.

Model answer: Local knowledge reveals routes, seasonal livelihood patterns, isolated households, informal shelters and trusted communicators that technical databases may miss. Scientific knowledge estimates hazard probability, intensity and spatial spread; administrative data identify roads, health facilities, transport and public authority. Combining them produces a fuller risk and resource map. Joint validation also checks errors: community memory may be outdated, hazard models may omit lived barriers and official lists may exclude tenants or migrants. Panchayat-led participatory mapping linked to DDMA planning therefore improves both accuracy and legitimacy. However, local knowledge should not be romanticised or used to reject authoritative forecasts. The correct model is complementary evidence: science clarifies the hazard, communities clarify exposure and feasible action, and administration supplies resources and accountability.

Original Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

Question: Why does volunteer enrolment not by itself establish disaster readiness?

Model answer: Enrolment measures programme reach, not deployable capacity. A ready volunteer system requires hazard-specific training, refresher practice, basic equipment, a verified roster, activation contacts, safety rules, supervision and referral to professional services. Attrition, migration and skill decay can make historic training figures misleading. Aapda Mitra is therefore best cited as an institutional capacity input rather than proof of reduced losses. Readiness should be tested through evaluated drills, time to activation, equipment availability, retention and safe performance. Volunteer schemes must also be representative so women, persons with disabilities, migrants and remote hamlets are not absent from local response. Thus the relevant chain is recruit, train, equip, activate, supervise and learn - not simply count.

Original Mains 3 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Design a disability-inclusive warning-to-shelter chain for an urban flood.

Model answer: A disability-inclusive chain begins before the alert. Ward-level participatory mapping should identify communication, mobility, medicine and support needs with consent and privacy safeguards. The authoritative warning should be delivered through audio, visual and text formats, plain language and trusted local relay; receipt and comprehension should be confirmed for households needing assistance. Evacuation plans must pre-assign accessible vehicles, safe routes and accountable support persons, with alternatives if lifts, roads or power fail. Shelters need barrier-free entry, accessible toilets, medicine and assistive-device continuity, registration of support needs and a feedback channel. Persons with disabilities should participate in drills and review because officials cannot infer every barrier. Section 8 of the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 and NDMA's 2019 disability-inclusive DRR guidelines provide legal and policy anchors, but publication does not prove implementation. Success should be measured through receipt, timely assisted evacuation, safe shelter access and correction of exclusion.

Original Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

Question: Discuss how relief systems can use community verification without reproducing local exclusion.

Model answer: Community verification can improve relief because SHGs, ward volunteers and local leaders know current occupancy, informal tenancies, disability, displacement and livelihood loss. They can identify households missing from official lists and monitor delivery. Yet local power may reproduce caste, gender, tenancy or migrant exclusion. Community control is therefore not automatically equitable. Relief systems should publish clear eligibility rules, permit multiple forms of identity and residence proof, record disaggregated needs, display delivery information with privacy safeguards and provide a time-bound appeal and correction process. Representative committees should include women, persons with disabilities, migrants and remote hamlets, while DDMA or municipal review supplies external accountability. Protection monitoring should track violence, trafficking, family separation and denial of health or sanitation services. The aim is a loop: transparent rule, delivery record, community check, grievance correction and updated list. Participation improves accuracy only when those excluded can challenge the local decision.

Original Mains 5 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: Critically examine the proposition that communities are the first responders in disasters.

Model answer: The proposition is operationally powerful but normatively incomplete. Communities are present at impact, know local routes and social networks and often act before professional forces arrive. With assigned roles, trained volunteers can relay warnings, guide evacuation, provide first aid, identify excluded households and support recovery. Odisha's cyclone-shelter committees and local rescue during the Kerala floods demonstrate this temporal and informational advantage. Aapda Mitra gives the principle an institutional form. However, a community is not homogeneous. Elite capture, caste and gender hierarchies, inaccessible communication, unsafe improvisation and volunteer attrition can reproduce risk. The phrase may also be misused to transfer the State's duty to under-equipped residents. A credible first-responder model therefore requires representative recruitment, training, equipment, activation protocols, safety limits, insurance or protection, professional referral and links to PRI/ULB and DDMA plans. Performance must be measured through receipt, safe action and inclusion rather than volunteer headcount. Communities are best understood as the first local layer within a publicly supported response system, not a substitute for specialised services or accountable government.

Original Mains 6 - 20 marks | 250 words

Question: Analyse how community-led recovery can reduce future risk while protecting displaced and marginalised groups.

Model answer: Community-led recovery improves fit because affected people understand livelihood cycles, settlement networks, service gaps and social priorities. Participation can guide housing location, infrastructure sequence, livelihood support and restoration of schools, health care and local markets. It also rebuilds agency and social capital, important for psychosocial recovery. Yet recovery can entrench risk if landowners dominate decisions, tenants and migrants lack documents, women are excluded from compensation or reconstruction restores unsafe sites. Disaster-displaced persons do not automatically become refugees under the 1951 Convention, but domestic and human-rights protection duties remain. Recovery should therefore use representative committees, participatory risk maps, multiple proof of residence, portable social protection, accessible reconstruction, livelihood grants, grievance redress and public monitoring. Build Back Better requires reducing the vulnerability revealed by the event, not merely rebuilding assets. Outcomes should be disaggregated by gender, disability, age, tenure and displacement status and should test service continuity, secure livelihood, corrected grievances and lower future risk. Community leadership is valuable when backed by public resources, rights and accountability.